

Green Manufacturing

Understanding Acer's big push towards eco-friendly manufacturing processes

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Acer's recent press conference saw the company making a huge push towards incorporating eco-friendly manufacturing initiatives. We had a chat with some of the key decision makers to understand how it all came together.

Mithun: Since, the Vero lineup launched last year, what is the market reception, and how much market share the Vero products have gained within their own respective segments?

James: Pandemic hurt many people's businesses and daily jobs, but we saw a very strong demand during the pandemic in education, gaming, commercials, and even in some other consumer segments. After the pandemic, we saw a drop in demand but the commercial segment was still there and the demand for gaming PC's was high.

Kao Jerry: From day one we shipped, even upto today, for 6-7 months we are always in a supply-shortage situation. 30 million is a large supply number which we could not fulfil. But if we are talking about an accurate number, we actually just had the first model until the Acer May event. Since then, we have had four more models. So from one year later, we can surely have statistics which make more sense.

Mithun: During the conference you mentioned that sustainability is an effort that will only succeed if we all take part in it. So I wanted to understand are there any government policies in place? Not speaking with specifics in regard to India or any other country, but I want to understand, are there governments who are taking an active role in putting up green initiatives that can help companies like Acer to come up with more sustainable product lines?

Kao Jerry: This is a company agenda, and when you are talking about who plays the most important role, the normal answer that you hear will be – the CEO. But the answer, if you ask me, is all the employees. Because we truly believe that this is something that a good company should do. To be honest, if we're talking about it as a CEO or a COO like me, of course the answer will be a change in business results. However, when we put the environment or sustainability as a high priority then we have to put other things as second priority. But do not get me wrong, we are not doing donation business or just ESG as a goodwill only. People are still paying for these products. However, we do not earn one more penny compared to our regular products and also we guarantee the same product assurance and quality as our other products. This is a company agenda and everybody is a part of it.

Mithun: Aside from the packaging, what is the scope of using recycled

materials in the products? In the conference, you mentioned that one company was helping you with the panel and also the touchpad is using ocean bound plastics. Are there other components in a laptop that can utilise recycled materials?

James: Keyboard is another one, which has a higher PCR that can go up to 50 per cent. Besides the packaging, even the inking which is used is water based and environment-friendly. We are also working on some of the metal parts to see if recycled materials can be incorporated. Another thing would be using different materials in the cables for which we are researching and working with our vendors.

Mithun: Apart from the Vero lineup the other product lineup which could be termed as the hero of the entire show were all the products using SpatialLabs 3D technology. You showcased gaming and creator focused laptops using the tech. I wanted to understand if we will be seeing large curved gaming monitors which also incorporate SpatialLabs features?

Jane: That is something that we would definitely love to do. Curved, may be a little difficult for many optical and physics reasons and making stereoscopic 3D becomes complicated. However, a larger screen for gaming or even a higher refresh rate are areas which we are exploring and it's definitely something that we think should be part of our product offering. That is something we are looking into. 



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